



MONTHLY UPDATE

Central African Republic: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25-2 · 21 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · CAPACITY · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

A month-long mobile outage at a northern town took out voice, data and mobile money together, and [left some officials unpaid for the previous month because salary transfers run over mobile services](#). It is the clearest record the base holds of what single-operator dependency costs.

The government declared the September 2025 memorandum on the incumbent operator's privatisation [in its operational phase on 16 July, with US\\$150m announced for network modernisation, a data centre and connectivity](#). Definitive agreements, a steering committee and a schedule are unfinalised, and the figure appears in no appropriation.

August brought two of the record's rarer things: an independent assessment and a working statistical apparatus. The World Bank's public finance review [put digitising the tax administration at up to two points of GDP](#), and the statistics institute both [advanced the first digital census through its third data-cleaning phase](#) and [published the aide-mémoire rebasing the national accounts to 2019](#), on top of the harmonised household survey it [put into the field on 20 July](#).

The regulator meanwhile [took its satellite-access rule into the field](#), estimating about 3,000 Starlink users against 200 registered.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The World Bank published a public finance review of the Central African Republic on 2 July 2026, and it puts digitisation at the centre of what it proposes. Against domestic revenue of about [FCFA 187bn, or 10.1% of GDP, in a 2025 budget of about FCFA 385bn](#), it argues for a rise to 12% in the short and medium term and 15% in the long term, and estimates that [digitising the tax administration alone could raise up to two points of GDP in the short term](#). Electronic public procurement and a digital cadastre are named among its longer-term recommendations, against [63% of public contracts let by direct award in 2023 and 11% of domestically financed investment executed that year](#).

It is the first independent assessment the base holds of the ground the government's own public-finances digitalisation plan 2025-2027 covers. That plan's costed operational annex, due in April 2025, is still unpublished.

Legislation and regulation

The cybersecurity and cybercrime law is unchanged in text and was [named by a commentator in July as the instrument now used against online content](#). That is an opinion column rather than a record of prosecutions, and the statute's own text is still not held.

Regional collaboration

The regional central bank and the payments body [launched an interoperable QR-code standard at Douala on 29 July under an April 2026 regulation](#), binding across the six member states, routed and settled through the regional switch and secured to card-industry standards. [The country's share of regional payment volume was 0.43% in 2024 – the smallest but one, against the largest member state's 65.10% – and no country-specific adoption step is on file](#). The regional report holds no value figure or account count for the country, so what the standard reaches here cannot be sized.

Standards

Enforcement of the satellite-access rule moved from communiqué to the street. On 12 August the regulator [began a control operation across Bangui – Damala, Benz-Vi and Miskine, and the Don Bosco and Marabéna roundabouts – to identify internet-access points absent from its own registers](#), on the digital economy minister's instruction. The ministry's estimate is [about 3,000 Starlink users in the country against 200 registered with the regulator](#), and the operation is to extend progressively to provincial cities.

Two of the operators visited said they had not been told registration was required and undertook to regularise. No register total is published, so the ratio stands on the ministry's own account.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Subscribers at a northern town reported [no calls, no internet and no mobile money for close to a month, with no restoration date](#). The failure is attributed to off-grid relay sites, equipment theft and repair crews travelling hundreds of kilometres, on a network with one operator and no redundancy; the base held nothing on this locality before.

Data Storage

On 16 July the minister met the counterparty's operations vice-president, moving the [incumbent operator's privatisation into an operational phase](#). [US\\$150m is announced across network modernisation, a data centre and connectivity](#); the deal structure is undisclosed, and definitive takeover agreements, a joint steering committee and a deployment schedule are all still to be established. [It is the fourth attempted rescue of this operator, the prior one agreed in November 2020, needing EUR 20m and never funded](#).

DPI

Digital Payments and Fintech

Mobile money is the salary rail outside the banked areas, and it failed with the network. The most recent enrolment figure held remains [1,702 civil servants in regions without banking services](#), recorded as a project achievement in May 2025; at the affected town, [prepaid bundles expired unused while the network was down](#).

On 30 July a memorandum was signed at Bangui covering [digital finance and land banking, presented as mobilising investment for infrastructure while modernising land administration](#). No commitment figure, disbursement schedule or governance arrangement is stated, and it couples a payments ambition and a land-registry ambition under one offshore private counterparty.

Registries

Against the Bangui memorandum, the cadastre itself has no delivery record: the 2026 medium-term framework carries [FCFA 625,000 for updating the mining cadastre and FCFA 650,000 for a petroleum database](#), FCFA 1,275,000 between them for the year.

Sectoral management information systems

Health information in the window is a single link run by someone other than the state. A remote hospital [is using telemedicine to reach a global network of healthcare professionals](#), the service run by an international medical organisation rather than the health ministry. One site is a capability and not yet a system: no case volume, connectivity arrangement or continuity plan is published, so what happens to the link when the organisation leaves is not on record.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Modernisation works opened at the central treasury accounting agency on 27 July for an [application deployed for the treasury single account, tied to regional banking rules and integrated with the regional settlement rails](#). Its stated object is centralising state balances and eliminating parallel and opaque accounts. No cost, financier, vendor, timetable or number of accounts closed is stated, and the architecture is explicitly regional rather than national — the public finances plan of June 2025 named six systems and a data centre and no treasury single account application.

Capacity

Research institutions

Nothing moved in the research base this period. What changed is the record: the base had carried no university, statistics-institute or donor research document for the country at all, and now holds the University of Bangui's [Institut superieur de technologie](#), which supplies most of the country's professional engineering graduates and runs a master's in engineering sciences. The page carries no date, enrolment or research-output figure, so the position it settles is one of existence rather than of scale.

Data

National statistics

The statistics institute [deployed enumerator teams nationwide on 20 July, opening six months of collection across about 7,000 households in three two-month waves, entirely by tablet](#), with a public commitment to statistical secrecy and aggregates only. The field period ends around January 2027; no results date is stated and no prior harmonised survey is held.

Two further statistical operations surfaced in August, both financed by the World Bank. The [third data-cleaning phase of the fourth population and housing census was presented on 6 August](#), a step toward definitive results from the country's first digital census; cleaning has been running since May 2026, under the HISWACA-SOP2 project with UNFPA as technical partner. No enumeration total or publication date is stated.

The institute also [released the aide-mémoire on rebasing the national accounts to 2019 under SCN 2008](#), moving off a 2005 base built on SCN 1993 and drawing on the 2021 agriculture and household living-conditions surveys to widen coverage of agriculture, household consumption, self-build, imputed rent and informal activity. The peer review it records was held in February 2023; what is new is its publication, and the record states no rebased GDP level.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The [privatisation memorandum's move to an operational phase](#) is carried here because the counterparty is a United States firm. [The announced US\\$150m is the counterparty's own figure and appears in no appropriation.](#)

Gulf/UAE activities

The [digital finance and land-banking memorandum signed at Bangui on 30 July](#) is the only Gulf-state item the base holds for the country at any date, and its counterparty is otherwise undocumented. It carries no commitment figure, disbursement schedule, timetable or governance arrangement, and registers as intent rather than finance.

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